

CUSTOMER & MVP BLUEPRINT

AI Resume & Interview Coach | India (Phase 1)

Derived from Startup Validation Report — July 2026

Executive Summary

This blueprint translates the Startup Validation Report's findings into a build-ready customer and MVP plan. The core problem — a widening gap between India's ~5M annual graduates and ~2.8M graduate-level jobs, with 60%+ of resumes failing ATS screening — is well-documented and severe. But the solution space is crowded: at least 8 funded or traction-proven competitors (PrepFree, Resumeera.xyz, ResumeGyani, Dovira AI, Jobcopy, Internshala, Kickresume, Novoresume) already serve this exact wedge in India, several with 100K–200K+ monthly active users.

No direct validation (users, interviews, payments) exists yet. This blueprint's MVP is therefore scoped deliberately narrow — a single niche segment, a manual/semi-automated build, and a 30-day path to real evidence — rather than a full-featured platform competing head-on with incumbents.

Ideal Customer Profile

Attribute	Profile
Life stage	Final-year student or graduate within 0–18 months of graduation
Education	Undergraduate degree from a tier-2/tier-3 Indian institution
Location	Non-metro India, reliable smartphone internet access
Income sensitivity	High — will pay ₹99–₹499 for proven outcomes, not vague subscriptions
Digital behaviour	YouTube, Instagram, WhatsApp/Telegram placement groups; Hinglish search
Core motivation	Get *any* interview call — driven by underconfidence, not career optimization

Buyer Persona

"Ankit, the Anxious Final-Year Applicant"

Age 21 • B.Tech Mechanical, tier-3 college, UP • First-generation graduate

Goal: Land any interview call before final semester ends.

Frustration: Unsure resume format is correct; freezes in mock interviews; can't afford ₹5,000+ coaching.

Willingness to pay: ₹99–₹299, only after peer proof — resists blind subscriptions.

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

#	Pain Point
1	Resume gets rejected before a human ever sees it (ATS filtering)
2	Freezes or rambles under real interview pressure
3	Doesn't know what recruiters actually look for
4	Can't afford professional resume writers or coaching institutes
5	Generic AI tools give Western-style advice, not Indian recruiter norms
6	Overwhelmed by conflicting advice across YouTube/forums
7	No accountability partner to actually practice interviews with
8	Can't tell if he's actually improving between attempts
9	Placement-cell support is generic, overloaded, and one-size-fits-all
10	Low confidence undermines performance even when skills are adequate

Customer Journey

Stage	Trigger	Customer State	Opportunity
Awareness	Placement notice or rejection email	Anxious, searching YouTube/Google	Be visible in placement WhatsApp groups & YouTube shorts
Consideration	Compares free vs. paid tools	Price-sensitive, skeptical of AI	Free ATS score check as hook; peer testimonials
Purchase	Needs unlimited downloads / more mock rounds	Has seen value, considers paying	Low-friction ₹99–₹299 one-time unlock
Retention	Gets an interview call or offer	Grateful, likely to refer peers	Referral loop into next cohort + college relationship

Key Customer Objections

Objection	Response
"Free tools already exist"	Lead with outcome proof (interview-call uplift), not features
"I don't trust AI on something this important"	Sample outputs + peer social proof + free trial
"I'll just ask ChatGPT for free"	India-specific ATS tuning + structured practice + progress tracking
"My college already has a placement cell"	Position as supplement, not replacement

Key Buying Triggers

- Placement season / campus drive announcements (highest intent)
- Just received a rejection or application ghosting
- A friend/senior got a call after using a similar tool
- College career cell recommends resume review before drive registration

MVP Recommendation

Build First

- AI/human-reviewed resume feedback + ATS score for ONE niche segment (e.g., tier-2/3 engineering students)
- A short, structured mock-interview question set with written feedback (voice/video optional later)
- Delivery via WhatsApp/Telegram + a simple landing page — no native app needed
- One-time ₹99–₹299 payment unlock (UPI) to test real willingness-to-pay

Do NOT Build Yet

- Native mobile app
- Voice/video AI interview analysis
- Job-matching or job-board integration
- Multi-language / regional-language support
- B2B college dashboard or enterprise features

Success Metrics

Metric	Target (30 days)
Structured user interviews completed	15–20
Landing page → signup conversion	Clear signal (>10–15%)
Real payments collected (not stated intent)	≥10 paying users
Institutional (college/placement-cell) conversations opened	≥1

MoSCoW Prioritization

Must Have	AI/manual resume review + ATS score · Mock-interview question set with feedback · WhatsApp/Telegram delivery · UPI one-time payment · Single niche focus
Should Have	India-specific resume templates · Objection-handling content library · Simple referral mechanism
Could Have	Voice-based mock interviews · Progress-tracking dashboard · College partnership portal
Won't Have (MVP)	Native app · Multi-language support · Job-matching/marketplace · Enterprise B2B dashboard · Video interview analysis

Pricing Hypothesis

- Freemium entry: free ATS score check + 1 free mock question (acquisition hook, matches market price anchor already set by competitors)
- Core paid unlock: ₹99–₹299 one-time for full resume review + mock-interview set (matches target segment's proven willingness-to-pay)
- Avoid recurring subscription at launch — target segment resists blind subscriptions; validate with one-time purchases first
- Future B2B2C layer: per-student or flat licensing fee to colleges/placement cells once individual model is proven

Top 5 Risks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Funded, distribution-rich competitors (PrepFree, Resumeera)	High	High	Avoid head-on positioning; win a narrow niche + college channel first
Commoditized AI features	High	Medium	Moat via India-specific rubrics & trust, not raw AI capability
Low willingness-to-pay	Medium	High	Validate with real ₹ payments in Week 3, not survey answers
Side-project bandwidth limits speed	High	Medium	Timebox to 30 days; decide full-time commitment on real signal
AI advice accuracy for Indian recruiter norms	Medium	High	Human-in-the-loop review during early cohorts

30-Day MVP Plan

Week	Focus	Actions
1	Talk to market	15–20 structured interviews with final-year students/grads; map current tools & spend
2	Narrow niche & test demand	Pick one segment/college; build landing page; drive signups via network & WhatsApp
3	Ship Wizard-of-Oz MVP	Manually deliver resume review + mock feedback for 15–20 signups; charge ₹99–₹299
4	Decide & plan	Review conversion/payment/feedback vs. Go/No-Go criteria; scope v1 or pivot

Founder Action Sheet — Top 10 Next Actions

#	Action
1	Pick one niche segment (e.g., one tier-2/3 college or engineering branch) — write it down, commit
2	Interview 15–20 target students this week — ask about their last rejection, not opinions
3	Build a 1-page landing page describing the specific promise for that niche
4	Share it in 3–5 relevant WhatsApp/Telegram placement groups

#	Action
5	Reach out to 1 college placement cell for a pilot conversation
6	Manually deliver resume review + mock interview feedback to first 10–20 signups
7	Charge a real ₹99–₹299 fee via UPI — do not give it away free
8	Track the same 2–3 pain points across interviews — confirm or kill the hypothesis
9	Collect 3–5 testimonials/referrals from satisfied early users
10	Review results against Go/No-Go criteria on Day 30 — decide before building more

Scores (0–100)

Dimension	Score	Why
Customer Clarity	75 / 100	ICP & persona well-defined; not yet confirmed with real interviews
Problem Severity	85 / 100	Backed by national labour data — structural, not anecdotal
PMF Potential	45 / 100	Real demand exists, but category is crowded with funded incumbents
MVP Readiness	35 / 100	Concept well-scoped, but zero users, interviews, or payments collected yet

Final Verdict



PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

Strong, data-backed problem and clear customer profile — but zero direct evidence (users, interviews, payments) and a crowded competitive field. Run the 30-day MVP plan before further product investment.